

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 698

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Charles Maxwell
"Charlie" Severance of Knox County.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Charles Maxwell "Charlie" Severance of Knox County; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Severance was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born on September 17, 1939, in Fountain City, Mr. Severance was the son of Don and Florence Severance; he graduated from Central High School and attended the University of Tennessee (UT) on a football scholarship; and

WHEREAS, Charlie Severance was later honored on the Central High School Wall of Fame and inducted into the Greater Knoxville Sports Hall of Fame; he is perhaps best known for his participation in "The Stop," a legendary play in UT football history; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Severance served for many years on the Fountain City Recreation Commission; his dedication to his fellow citizens extended to his service as a Tennessee State Representative to the General Assembly and Assistant Commissioner of State Parks for the Department of Conservation and Environment; and

WHEREAS, in addition to being an avid UT fan, Mr. Severance was a gifted storyteller, who was the life of the party and quick with a joke; and

WHEREAS, Charlie Severance was deeply devoted to his family, and he always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, he will be sadly mourned but fondly remembered by his wife of sixty-six years, Phyllis Bales Severance; his sons, Chuck (Kim) Severance, Marcus (Jamie) Severance,

and Michael (Robin) Severance; his grandsons, Connor (Dezirae) Sepesi, Garrett Sepesi, Michael Christian Severance, Gabriel Severance, Hagan (Katie) Severance, Ben Severance, and Wyatt Severance; his great-grandchildren, Carter Severance, Collins Severance, and Walker Sepesi; his brother, Bill (Peggy) Severance; and a host of extended family and dear friends; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his parents, he was preceded in death by his brother, Lieutenant Colonel Donald Marcus Severance, Jr.; and

WHEREAS, Charlie Severance leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Charles Maxwell "Charlie" Severance, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we extend our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Severance.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.